

Vertigo



Photo Heading up from Tukino Lodge to the Whangaehu Hut (Nigel Roberts)

Newsletter of the New Zealand Alpine Club, Wellington Section

www.facebook.com/nzacwellington

Section News

October section night – Wellington Section Photo Competition Awards

The awards evening is to be held at the October Section night, 7pm 13 October at the Tararua Tramping Club. Come along and see the winning photos from the Wellington section photo competition. Please note the earlier start time.

The competition includes categories for :

- ALPINE ACTIVITY: climbing, skiing, whatever you do up high
- ALPINE GENERAL: scenery and views that make you want to come back
- ALPINE NATURE the little gems of beauty along the way
- ROCK CLIMBING: hardest moves, slickest lines
- PHOTOJOURNALISM: the shot that tells a story
- HUMOUR: whatever gets you a laugh

Big thanks go to our competition sponsors:

- Wilderness magazine
- Bivouac Outdoor
- LED Lenser
- Sprig & Fern Tavern
- HangDog climbing gym.

Please return their support wherever you can.



Alpine Activity Winning Photo 2013 - Aspiring NW Ridge - by Lars Hansen

Ask not what your Section can do for you...

Hi all -

If the recent snowfall or launch of North Island Rock Deluxe didn't get you excited, then hopefully the prospect of summer climbing trips has!

Early summer is also AGM season, and we have some vacancies to fill in the Section committee.

Our section has 400 members, most of whom usually have little contact with the Section, but nonetheless the section needs to keep ticking over, and it's time to reach out.

The section has always relied on a small changing cast of volunteers to deliver instruction courses, manage instructor development, organise section nights, photo competitions and the Banff Film Festival nights, produce monthly Vertigo newsletters, manage Facebook and the section website, coordinate with National Office and organise trips and other activities.

Every few years the Section committee renews itself as folks step down and section members new and old step up. This is a great chance to give a little and to shape the section activities - if you'd like more trips, more social nights etc, then get involved and see what you can make happen.

There will be several spaces open at the AGM Monday 9th November and we'd love to have some new and old faces join. To learn more, suggest someone or step up yourself, please email wellington@alpineclub.org.nz or give me a call.

Kind regards,

Dan Pringle, Outgoing Chair - 027 768-2185

Vertigo Articles and Photos Needed

Hopefully you all enjoy receiving and reading Vertigo each month. As editor I get to read articles sent in and view amazing photos before putting Vertigo together and sent out to you. If you've been on a trip recently or perhaps have something climbing related to write about (gear or technique recommendation?) I'd love to be able to include a report in Vertigo. Trip reports from the climbing gurus through to us lesser mortals make interesting reading so please put pen to paper (or finger to keyboard) and send through your offerings before the last week of the month for inclusion in Vertigo. Photos to support the written word are great - please provide captions and identify the photographer. To get your photo on the front page of Vertigo it needs to be in portrait format please. All stories, notices and photos can be sent to me (Carolyn) at kaz1963@gmail.com

Section Nights are usually at the Tararua Tramping Club clubrooms, 4 Moncrieff Street, Mount Victoria, Wellington on the second Monday of every month. New and prospective members are welcome. Meetings start 8.00 pm with tea & coffee afterwards

Trip Reports

Ruapehu's refurbished and repaired Whangaehu Hut re-opened

By Nigel Roberts

Five members of the Wellington section of the Alpine Club – Jenna Cock, Don French, Jordan Poste, Dan Pringle, and Nigel Roberts – were present at the re-opening of the NZAC's Whangaehu Hut on Mt Ruapehu on Saturday, 6 September 2014.

A party of twenty-eight climbers set off from the Tukino Lodge (which many members of the Wellington section think of with affection as 'Don French's lodge'!) at 9:30 in the morning and made its way slowly – taking about two hours in inclement weather – up to the Whangaehu Hut.

The original Whangaehu Hut was designed and built by members of the Auckland section of the Alpine Club during the summer of 1963-64, and Sir Edmund Hillary officially opened the hut on 28 March 1964.



Arriving in less-than-perfect conditions at the NZAC's Whangaehu Hut, Mt Ruapehu

During the half-century since it was first opened, the elements – especially wind and snow – took their toll on the Whangaehu Hut. Consequently, members of the Central North Island (CNI) section of the Alpine Club – based around but not solely in Hamilton – responded to the challenge of repairing and rebuilding the hut.

When the refurbished hut was ready to be re-opened, it was decided that Peter Hillary would be the perfect person to re-open it. After all, he'd been present as a nine-year-old when his father first opened the hut in 1964!



Peter Hillary, David Hoyle and Peter Aimer at the Whangaehu Hut after it had been officially re-opened by Peter Hillary. David Hoyle designed the original hut (which was initially assembled in his back yard in Auckland)



After brief speeches and the unveiling of a plaque commemorating both the opening and the re-opening of the hut – accompanied, of course, by champagne toasts – members of the hut re-opening party headed back down to the Tukino Lodge, where a splendid Saturday night 'black-tie' dinner rounded-out the Alpine Club's celebrations marking the re-opening of the Whangaehu Hut.



The 'black-tie' dinner in the Tukino Lodge on Saturday night, 6 September 2014, that rounded-out the celebrations marking the re-opening of the Alpine Club's Whangaehu Hut.

The Whangaehu Hut is situated at 2,080 metres / 6,824 feet above sea-level on the eastern side of Mt Ruapehu. The refurbished hut sleeps eight comfortably (and more intimately), and is a great base for exploring the crags and slopes above Tukino. Wellington section members are encouraged to use it – summer and winter.

Notices

20% discount – A Long Cold Paddle – Craig Potton Publishing

A Long Cold Paddle by Tara Mulvany is on special with 20% discount until the end of the year. Please log in online for member rates:

<https://alpineclub.org.nz/news/2014/craig-potton-publishing/a-long-cold-paddle/discount>

Request for short videos from UIAA / IUCN

The International Climbing and Mountaineering Federation (UIAA) have passed on a request from the International Union for the Conservation of Nature for short, compelling videos of alpinists promoting the UIAA and the protection of mountain environments around the world. The following link provide more information :

[UIAA-videos-WPC2014.pdf](#)

UIAA Youth Camps

The UIAA, with the financial support of the ARISF (Association of IOC Recognised International Sports Federations), organises, every year, international camps for young people (<http://www.theuiaa.org/global-youth-summit.html>). This is very important, as it prepares future generations of mountaineers and climbers and mountains lovers.

Almost every year, the French, Italian, South African, Russian and Georgian Federations generously offer to organise such camps. Unfortunately, we still lack participants from more countries, as well as more federation organisers.

I would like to encourage you to help us and do some promotion among your young members and eventually propose such an international camp in your country. You can find the booklet on our page <http://www.theuiaa.org/organiser-guidelines.html> . This would be a great chance for young climbers. Please take the opportunity to talk to Israfil Ashurli, our Youth commission president, at the UIAA future General Assembly in October or to contact me (valerie.thoeni@theuiaa.org).

I thank you for your understanding and hope to get positive news from you.

With best regards

Valérie Thöni

UIAA collaborator

Youth-Mountain Protection-Mountaineering

Wanted : New Zealand Alpine Journal 2008

If you have a spare copy of the 2008 Alpine Journal please contact Tom Hu on:

Email: tomyuhu@gmail.com

Home: 03 3433 887

Text: 0226 589 688.

Expedition Reports – Anidesha Chuli/White Wave Expedition 2014

Paul and Shelley Hersey along with John Price attempted the first ascent of Anidesha Chuli or White Wave (6815m), NE Nepal. As they were NZAC grant recipients, you can read their expedition report online here: <https://alpineclub.org.nz/expedition-fund/reports/grants/history>



Anidesha Chuli Exp 2014 (image John Price)

Any other expedition reports from past grant recipients would be greatly appreciated. Please email through to Margaret@alpineclub.org.nz if you have received an NZAC grant over the years, but do not see it featured on this webpage.

DOC Memorial Books

DOC are seeking images of the following past NZAC members : Michael Drayton Goldsmith – Melville James Pitt Glasgow – Ronald John Ferguson – Paul Gazley

If anyone has any good quality scans, or can lend us some images to copy it would be greatly appreciated. Please email Margaret@alpineclub.org.nz, or post to her at NZAC, PO Box 786, Christchurch 8140. We have some images from old Journals, but they don't scan too well, so are after originals, or better quality images, thanks.

Club Donation Fund Supporters

With the demise of the Expedition Capital Fund, the two remaining retail sponsors have decided to continue with their direct support of NZAC. Cactus have chosen to follow the Expedition Fund and Splitn2.com, the Club Huts Fund. We thank them for this and encourage members to take advantage of the 10% discount on purchases, which then leads to an additional donation by the retailers to the funds based on those purchases. Further details online: <https://alpineclub.org.nz/benefits-of-membership>

Changes to Unwin Lodge hut fees

There have been some changes to fees at Unwin Lodge (pictured below) :

<https://alpineclub.org.nz/news/2014/unwin-lodge-aoraki-mt-cook-hut-fee-changes>

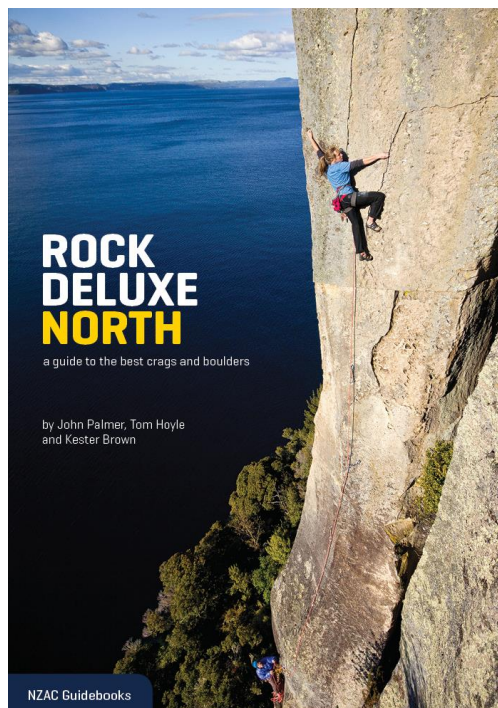


Unwin Lodge (Image - Mark Watson)

Rock Deluxe North guidebook

The NZAC's first guide to the best crags and boulders in NZ's North Island - \$45 + p&p (members price). Sample chapter available and link to purchase the guide online :

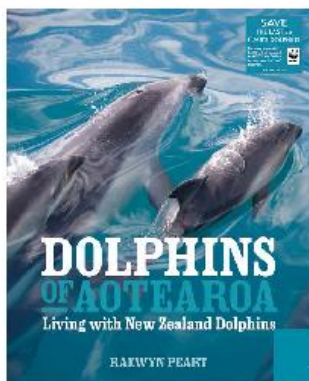
<http://alpineclub.org.nz/product/rock-deluxe-north>



Save the last 50 Maui's Dolphins

Craig Potton Publishing has partnered up with World Wildlife Fund New Zealand to save the last remaining 55 Maui's Dolphins. They are offering 50% discount Firm Sale off copies of Dolphins of Aotearoa and will be donating \$5.00 to the WWF NZ for every copy sold. Please use the following order form to place your book and POS Poster orders.

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Wellington Section 2013/14 contacts list

We are always thankful for volunteers and members stepping forward to help the section run smoothly. If you'd like to learn more about how you could get involved, please email us at wellington@alpineclub.org.nz

Position	Name	Email alias*	Contact
Chairperson	Dan Pringle	chairperson	027 768-2185
Vice Chair	Vincent Zintzen	vicechair	
Secretary	Julian Davidson	secretary or CM2	
Treasurer	Adam Newberry	treasurer	
National Rep	Dan Pringle		
Patron	John Nankervis		
Trips	Vacant	Trips	
Other Committee Members	Simon Williamson		
	John Yu		
	Sharran Came		
Other Roles:			
Gear	vacant	gear	
Personal Locator Beacons	vacant	PLB	
Instruction Coordinator	vacant		
Instruction - AIC	vacant		
Instruction - Rock	vacant		
Library	Joke Meerkens	library	
Newsletter Editor	Carolyn Ellis		Kaz1963@gmail.com
Rock Drill Overseer	Kristen Foley	drill or KF	
Website	John Yu	webmaster	
* Email address is: alias@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz eg. secretary@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz			
Any membership, Distaghil Sar Fund, or general queries should be directed to the secretary			
Any media queries should be directed to:			
03 3777 595	National Executive Officer	Sam Newton	sam@alpineclub.org.nz



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